

MOCKINGBIRDS AND RELATIVES

Birds of the family Mimidae occur throughout much of the Americas, and the Caribbean and Galapagos Islands. Usually grey or brown, these strong-legged birds are highly vocal; some are accomplished mimics.



21–26 cm
8½–10 in

NORTHERN MOCKINGBIRD

Mimus polyglottos
This N. American bird is famous for its extraordinary repertoire of varied songs, which it delivers day and night.



27 cm
10½ in

CURVE-BILLED THRASHER

Toxostoma curvirostre
A bird of arid, scrubby habitats in the S. USA and Mexico, this species uses its long bill to probe the soil for invertebrates.



21–24 cm
8½–9½ in

GREY CATBIRD

Dumetella carolinensis
Named for its cat-like mewing call, this N. American bird forages on the ground. It overwinters in C. America and the Caribbean.

OXPECKERS

In the family Buphagidae, oxpeckers bound low over African savannas in undulating flight. Although their strong feet provide a tight grip on the hide of large animals as the birds feed, their short legs are unsuitable for walking on the ground.

YELLOW-BILLED OXPECKER

Buphagus africanus
Common in savanna across sub-Saharan Africa, this bird habitually perches on large mammals, eating parasites but also pecking at wounds.



19–22 cm
7½–9 in



27–31 cm
10½–12 in

HILL MYNA

Gracula religiosa
Found in forests of tropical Asia, this species is a popular cage bird. It is notable for its melodious call and its mimicking ability.



50 cm
20 in

WHITE-NECKED MYNA

Streptocitta albigollis
This long-tailed, magpie-like myna is restricted to rainforests in Sulawesi, Indonesia, and adjacent islands, where it usually associates in pairs.



25 cm
10 in

BALI MYNA

Leucopsar rothschildi
Found only in the rainforests of Bali, Indonesia, this striking bird is highly endangered by habitat destruction and the bird trade.

OLD WORLD FLYCATCHERS AND CHATS

Related to thrushes, the family Muscicapidae is divided into two groups: true flycatchers, with a broad bill for snatching flying insects; and chats, which include robins, nightingales, and wheatears. Some species are brightly coloured, but most of these small birds have predominantly grey or brown plumage.



14 cm
5½ in

EUROPEAN ROBIN

Erithacus rubecula
Related to chats, this bird of hedgerows and woodland is found in W. Eurasia and N. Africa. In Britain, it is a common garden visitor.



15–16 cm
6–6½ in

NORTHERN WHEATEAR

Oenanthe oenanthe
Wheatears are white-rumped chats of open country. This is the most widespread species across Eurasia. It winters in Africa.



18 cm
7 in

BLUE-AND-WHITE FLYCATCHER

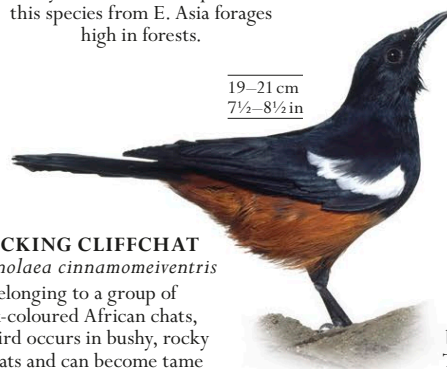
Cyanoptila cyanomelaena
Belonging to a large group of vivid blue flycatchers from tropical Asia, this species from E. Asia forages high in forests.



13 cm
5 in

COMMON STONECHAT

Saxicola torquatus
Typical of chats, this is a small, upright, perching insectivore with a harsh call. It is common in grassland in Eurasia and Africa.



19–21 cm
7½–8½ in

MOCKING CLIFFCHAT

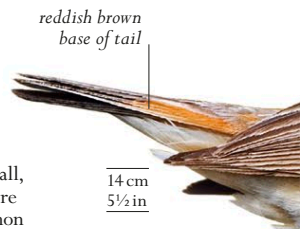
Thamnolaea cinnamomeiventris
Belonging to a group of dark-coloured African chats, this bird occurs in bushy, rocky habitats and can become tame near villages.



13–14 cm
5–5½ in

WHITE-BROWED SHORTWING

Brachypteryx montana
Now members of the flycatchers family, shortwings are running birds found in Asian forests. This species occurs from the Himalayas to Java, Indonesia.



14 cm
5½ in

COMMON REDSTART

Phoenicurus phoenicurus
Named for the reddish brown tail, redstarts are chat-like birds found mainly in Asia. This species occurs from W. to C. Eurasia and migrates to E. Africa.